Last-Minute Halloween Costume Checklist, Oct. 31, 2026

Store checks, what to buy and costume safety before Saturday

BEFORE YOU GO

- [ ] Find stores on the official locator by city or ZIP code — Thu., Oct. 29
- [ ] Open the exact store page for hours and call to confirm your size — Thu., Oct. 29
- [ ] Check the Staples page or store if you want Party City items — Thu., Oct. 29
- [ ] Test makeup on a small patch of skin (last day for 48 hours) — Thu., Oct. 29

BUY

- [ ] Costume, with wig and props if you need them — Fri., Oct. 30
- [ ] Accessories and non-toxic makeup you tested — Fri., Oct. 30
- [ ] Flame resistant label on the costume, wig and accessories — Fri., Oct. 30
- [ ] Ask about return terms for seasonal items — Fri., Oct. 30

SAFETY

- [ ] Hem short enough to prevent tripping and catching on objects — Sat., Oct. 31
- [ ] Flashlight and reflective tape for the walk — Sat., Oct. 31
- [ ] Makeup or a hat in place of a mask — Sat., Oct. 31
- [ ] No decorative contact lenses without an eye exam and prescription — Sat., Oct. 31

My notes

Source: American Academy of Pediatrics (HealthyChildren.org, updated Sept. 29, 2026); U.S. Food and Drug Administration (content as of Oct. 19, 2023); Spirit Halloween store locator; Staples and Party City release, Apr. 21, 2026.